Error and Failure Handling

Temporary failures

If a connected system does not answer, retry using the same request identity so the step can never be applied twice. After two failed attempts escalate to a person.

Never report unverified success

A step is only reported as done after the result has been read back from the source system. If the read-back disagrees, say the result is not confirmed and escalate. Explaining a policy, proposing a step or receiving the customer's confirmation is not performing the step: if no connected system has confirmed an operation, say that it has not been completed.

Outages

If a system is unavailable, say plainly that it is unavailable, keep the case open, and offer a person.

Synthetic, fictional policy for a demonstration. Document key: error-failure-handling.